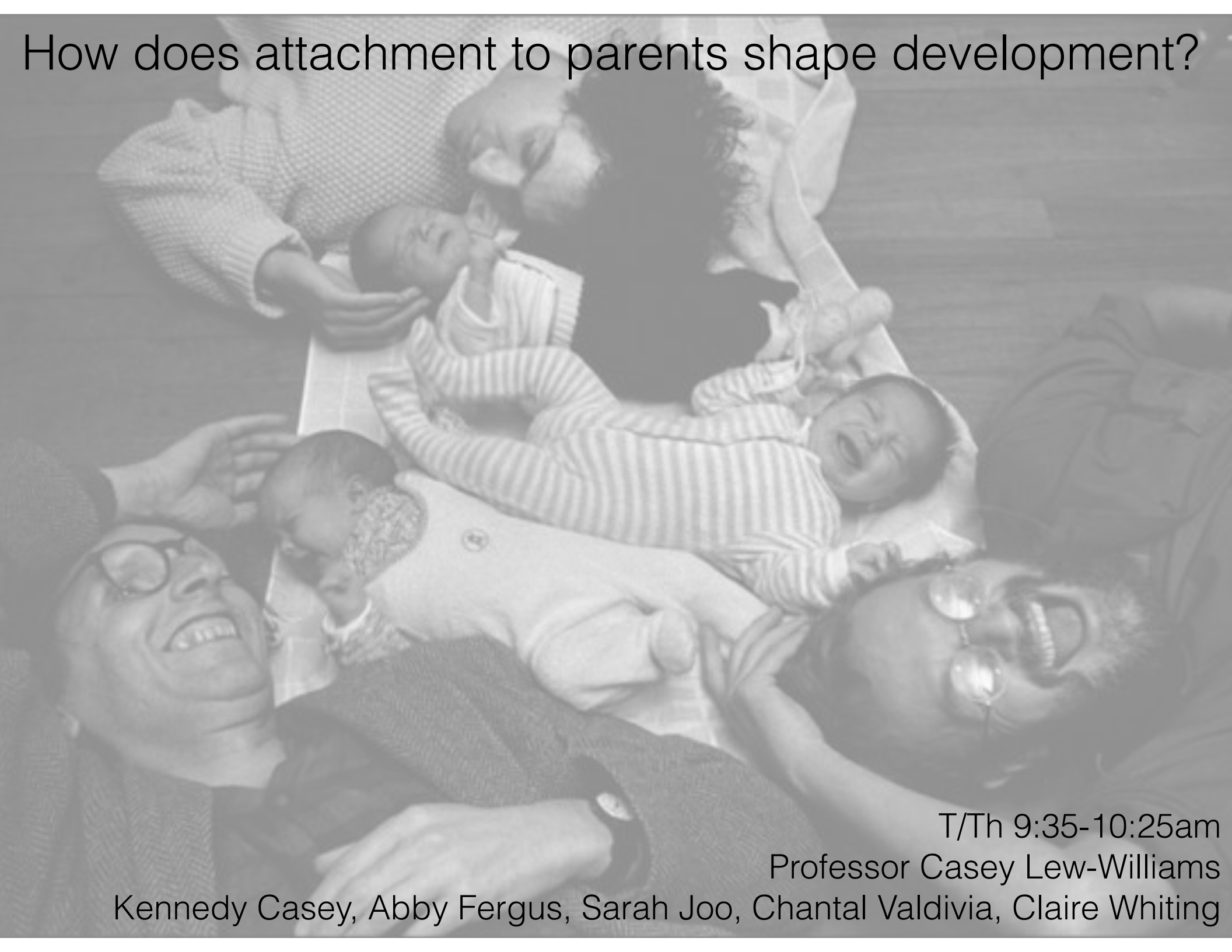


How does attachment to parents shape development?

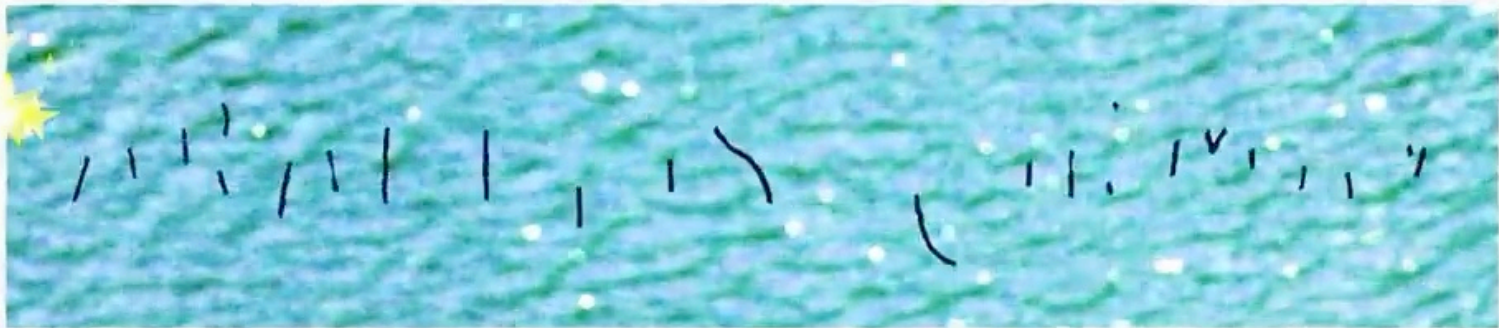


T/Th 9:35-10:25am

Professor Casey Lew-Williams

Kennedy Casey, Abby Fergus, Sarah Joo, Chantal Valdivia, Claire Whiting

LOISFOERIBARI, by Aracelis Girmay



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DcIYMCC0M1w>

Research participation requirement

- Don't forget about this! See syllabus.
- Be sure to fulfill your hours; otherwise it'll be a mess.
- Reach out to RoseMarie Stevenson with any questions, rosemari@princeton.edu

App/toy/book evaluation

- Due before your precept next week

Attachment to caregivers

... focusing on how children develop expectations about human relationships

Parenting styles

... focusing on variation in parenting

Harlow's monkeys

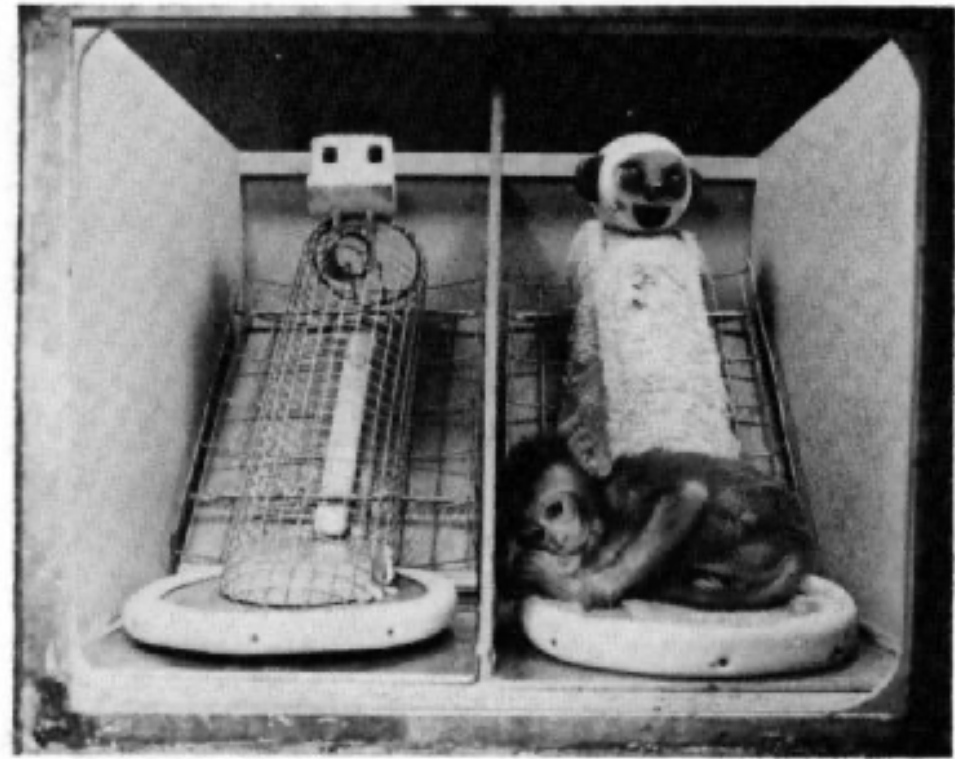


Figure 4. Wire and cloth mother surrogates.

Love is not just reward



Love is not just reward



John Bowlby (1908-1990)

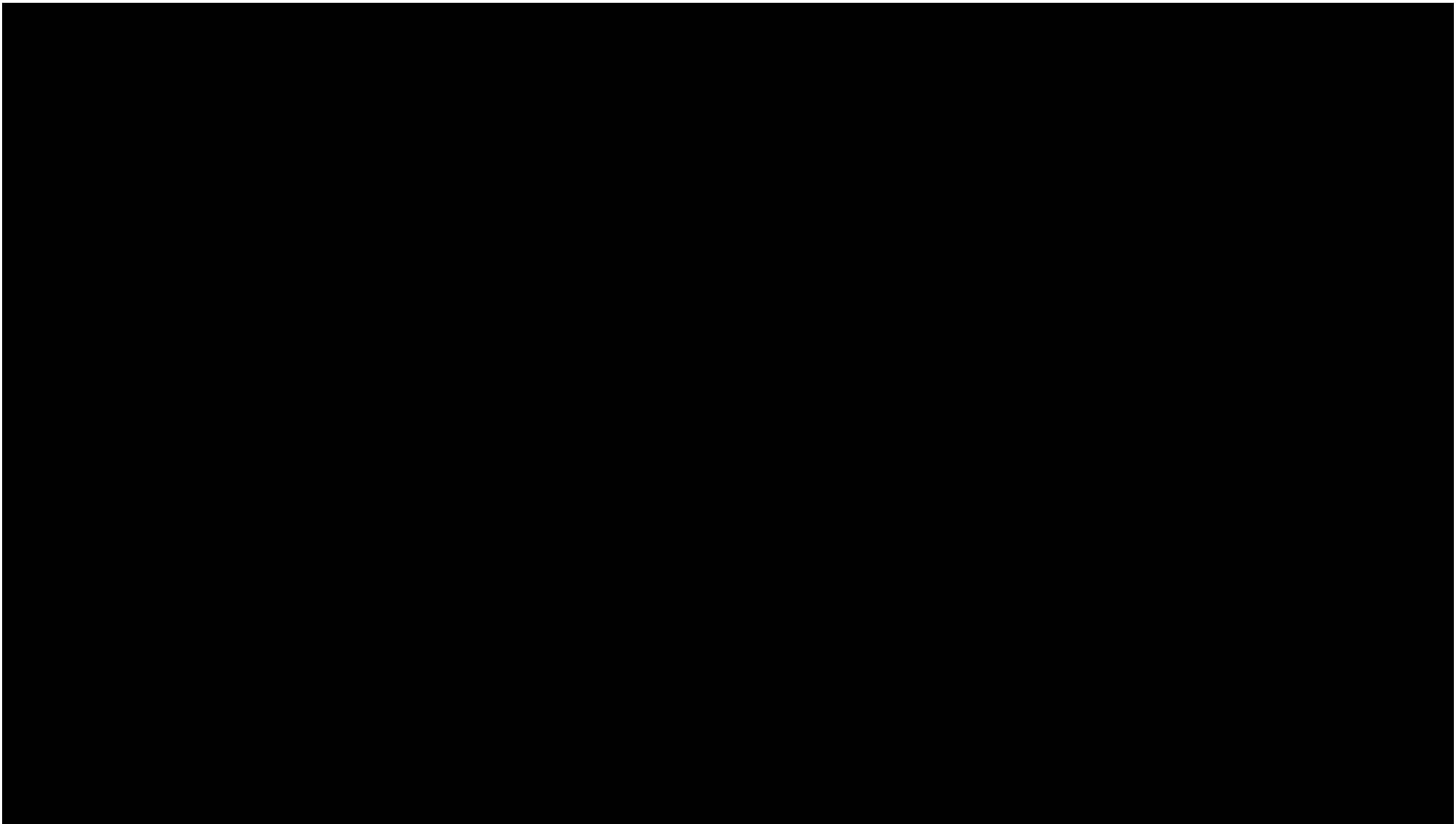


Mary Ainsworth (1913-1999)

Attachment as “secure base”



The “Strange Situation”



(Ainsworth et al., 1978, 2015)

Attachment “styles”

1. Secure (~60-65% of infants)
2. Insecure-avoidant (~20%)
3. Insecure-resistant-ambivalent (~10%)
4. Insecure-disorganized (~5-15%)

Bowlby's stages of attachment: 1. Preattachment phase

- 0-2 months
- Innate signals + parental responsiveness



2. Attachment-in-the-making

- 6-8 months
- Recognition of and preferential responding to caregivers



3. Clear-cut attachment

- up to ~2 years
- Active seeking, separation distress

4. Reciprocal relationships

- age 2 onwards
- Children as relationship partners



	Boys		Girls	
	Fathers	Mothers	Fathers	Mothers
Participates in tasks related to the child's needs				
Responsibility for bedtime*	4.4	4.8	4.4	4.5
Health needs*	3.5	4.9	2.9	4.6
Daily school needs*	1.5	4.9	1.8	5.0
Responsibility for dressing*	1.9	4.9	2.1	4.9
Parent-child interaction*				
Go over schoolwork*	4.2	4.8	4.1	4.8
Read to child*	4.0	4.3	4.1	4.8
Play with toys indoors	3.6	3.9	3.2	3.7
Play rough-and-tumble games*	4.2	3.1	3.7	2.8
Take to/watch sports	2.9	2.8	1.7	2.0
Go over a child's day*	4.7	5.0	4.4	4.7
Sit and talk	4.6	4.9	4.6	4.7
Go to park/beach	3.3	3.5	3.3	3.4

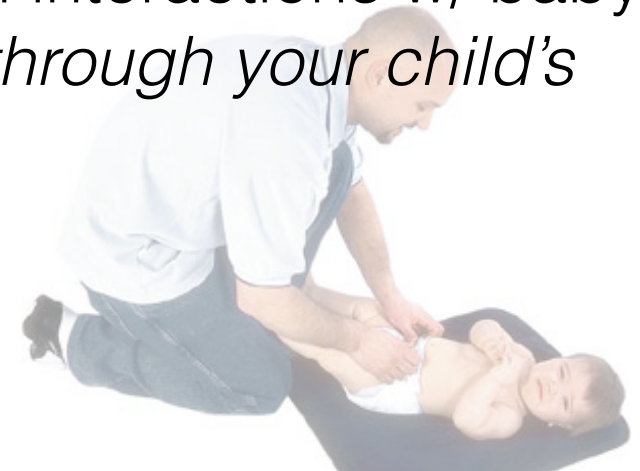
Adapted from Russell & Russell (1987)

Buck these trends someday!

Factors that influence attachment

- **Secure attachment**

- Close contact
 - Babies in Israeli kibbutzim
 - Soft vs. hard carriers
- Specific parenting behaviors
 - Sensitivity to babies' needs
 - Adjustment to baby's mood
 - Acceptance of baby in difficult times
 - Availability to baby physically and psychologically
- "Insightful" parenting
 - Parents watch videos of their own interactions w/ baby
 - Q: *What do you think was going through your child's head? What did she think, feel?*



Factors that influence attachment

- **Insecure-avoidant**
 - Caregivers don't respond as reliably to baby's signals
 - Less physical contact
 - More anger & irritability when together
- **Insecure-resistant-ambivalent**
 - Less affectionate and more inconsistent
- **Insecure-disorganized**
 - Neglect or physical abuse are somewhat more common
 - Maternal depression is more common

Factors that influence attachment

- **Infant temperament profiles**
 - “Easy” temperament // secure
 - “Slow-to-warm-up” temperament // avoidant
 - “Difficult” temperament // resistant/ambivalent



Factors that influence attachment

- but...
 - Infants can be securely attached to Person A but not B
 - Intervention study with parents of difficult infants
(van den Boom, 1994)
 - Parent problems loom larger than child problems

Why care about attachment?

Correlates of childhood attachment later in life:

- More positive, empathetic, and socially competent
- Harmonious peer relationships
- Healthy romantic relationships
- Better grades
- More school involvement
- Marital satisfaction
- Less jealousy
- Less prejudice

But why do attachment relationships predict anything at all?

Internal working models

Internal working models

- Belsky et al. (1996)
 - Assess attachment security at 12 months
 - Then, at 3 years, brought kids in for a memory task



Internal working models

- Belsky et al. (1996)

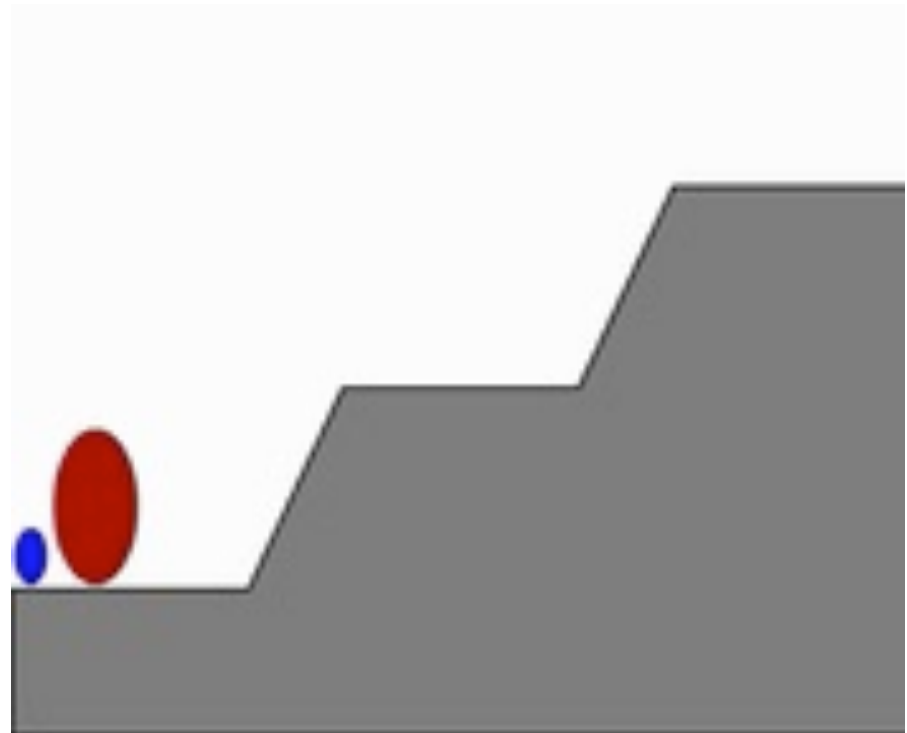
Table 1. *Mean adjusted attention and recognition memory scores of children with secure and insecure attachment histories*

Score	Secure (<i>n</i> = 29)		Insecure (<i>n</i> = 24)	
	Positive events	Negative events	Positive events	Negative events
Attention	3.06 (2.14)	3.52 (2.26)	3.30 (2.44)	4.32 (2.89)
Memory	8.19 (2.98)	7.11 (2.50)	6.64 (3.31)	8.30 (2.13)

Internal working models

- Johnson, Dweck, & Chen (2010)
 - 13-month-old participants
 - First: Strange Situation
 - Then: tested infants' expectations...

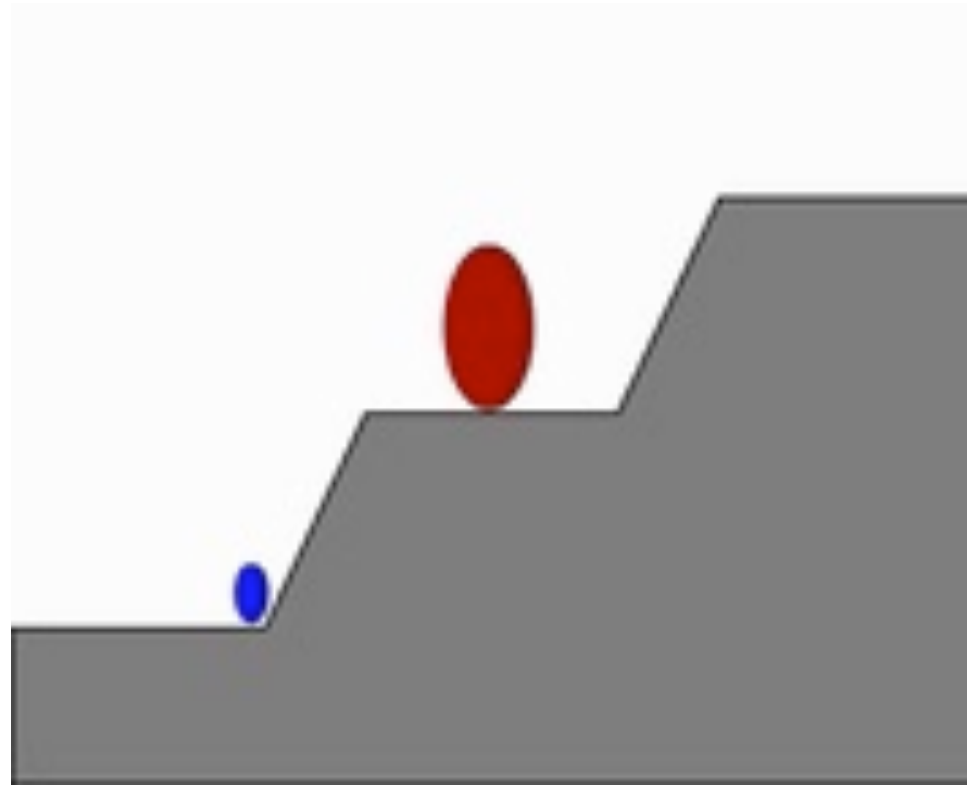
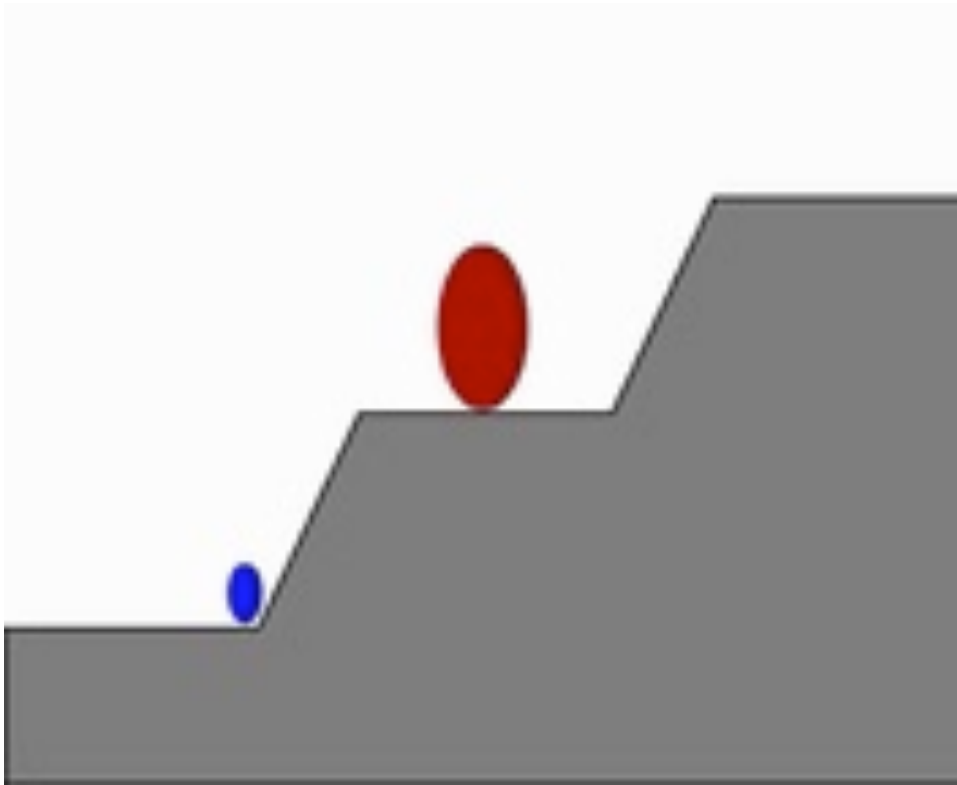
Habituation event:
separation



Internal working models

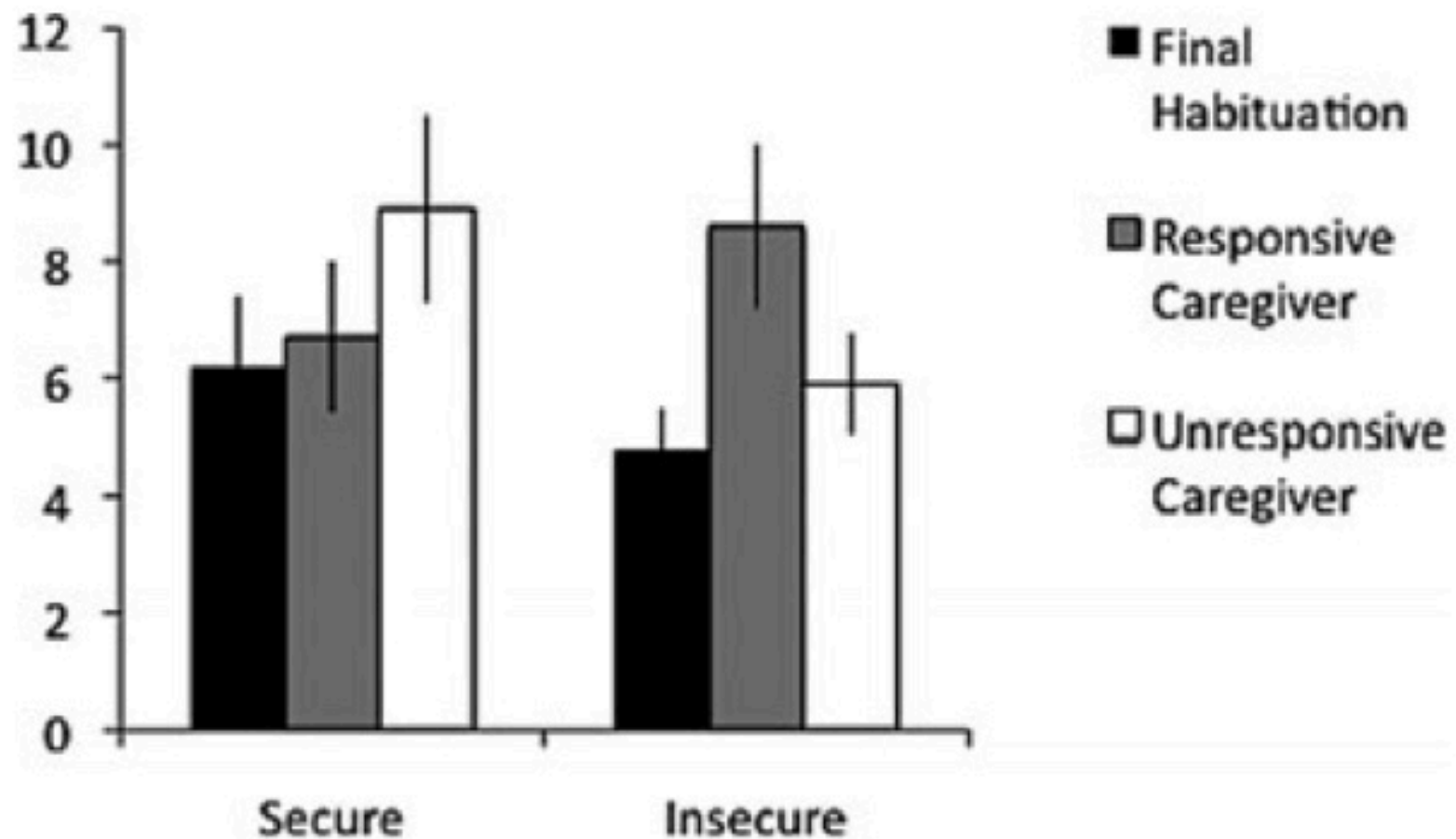
- Johnson, Dweck, & Chen (2010)

Test events:
responsive vs. unresponsive caregiver



Internal working models

- Johnson, Dweck, & Chen (2010)



Parenting styles



Parenting styles

...according to Diana Baumrind

Emotionality

Warm & Responsive

Rejecting & Unresponsive

Control

Restrictive &
Demanding

Permissive &
Undemanding

Authoritative

Authoritarian

Permissive

Uninvolved

Parenting styles

...according to Diana Baumrind



Authoritative	Authoritarian	Permissive	Uninvolved
Warm	Little warmth	Moderately warm	Self-centered
Involved	Does not ask for child's opinions	Glorifies free expressions of impulses and desires	Unresponsive
Considers child's wishes & opinions	Enforces rules, but doesn't explain	Does not set or enforce clear rules	Tries to minimize interactions with the child
Set clear standards	Shows displeasure	Does not set or enforce clear rules	Doesn't monitor where the child is or whether he/she is safe
Is firm	Punitive discipline	Ignores bad behavior	May be depressed and needy
Confronts disobedience	Views child as "wild"	Yields to coercion	
High expectations			

Parenting styles

...according to Diana Baumrind



Parent	Child
Authoritative	<u>Preschool</u> : energetic & friendly; socially competent <u>Childhood</u> : high cognitive & social competence <u>Adolescence</u> : high self-esteem & academic competence
Authoritarian	<u>Preschool</u> : conflicted & irritable; fearful & moody <u>Childhood</u> : average cognitive & social competence <u>Adolescence</u> : average academics, more conforming
Permissive	<u>Preschool</u> : impulsive & aggressive <u>Childhood</u> : low cognitive & social competence <u>Adolescence</u> : poor self-control, more drug use
Uninvolved	<u>Preschool</u> : aggressive, noncompliant, moody <u>Childhood</u> : disruptive, poor classroom performance <u>Adolescence</u> : hostile, selfish, rebellious

Sources of variation in parenting styles

- Quality of marriage
 - Parent personality
 - Parent mental health
 - Parents' own experiences as children
 - Parent genetics
-
- Additional sources of variation...

Sources of variation in parenting styles

1. Children themselves

- Parent effects model: parent $\longrightarrow$ child
- Child effects model: child $\longrightarrow$ parent
- Transactional model: child $\longleftrightarrow$ parent

Sources of variation in parenting styles

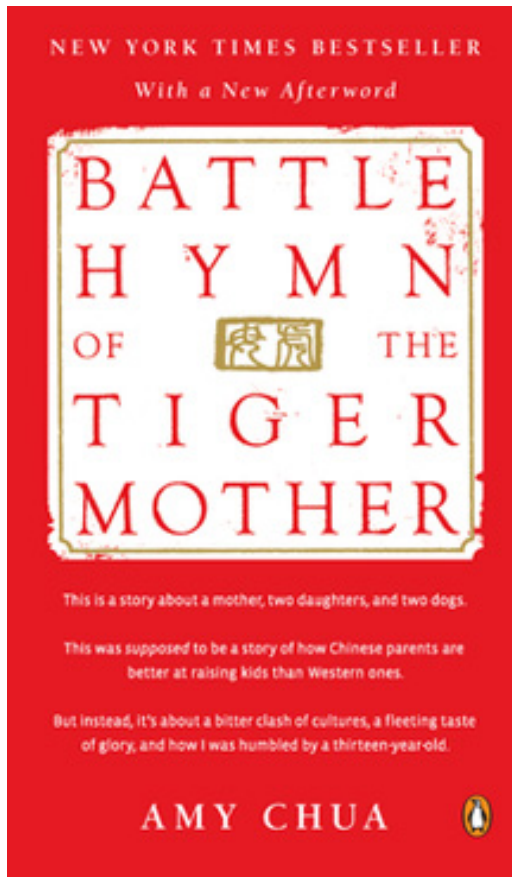
2. SES

- On average, lower-SES families in W.E.I.R.D. cultures (relative to middle-class families) tend to...
 - stress obedience and respect for authority
 - be more restrictive and authoritarian
 - reason with their children less frequently
 - show less warmth
- Why?



Sources of variation in parenting styles

3. Culture



THE SATURDAY ESSAY | JANUARY 8, 2011

Why Chinese Mothers Are Superior



Sources of variation in parenting styles

3. Culture

- Study of Chinese vs. (mostly white) U.S. parents: Chinese parents reported slightly lower warmth and acceptance, and more use of physical coercion. (Wu et al., 2002)
 - But should we really use the term 'authoritarian' to describe this?
- Expressions of love can be lost in translation. Chinese American parents draw on multiple cultural scripts to express love (including high expectations and firm control), which in turn shape attachment security. (Williams, Liu, Zhou et al., 2024)
- In cross-cultural research, we should always ask ourselves:
 - What kind of variability is there *within* a social group? (there are 1.4 billion Chinese people in the world!)
 - Is the sample size big enough to make sound conclusions?
 - How do we balance the goals of discussing group differences yet avoiding stereotyped thinking?

Sources of variation in parenting styles

3. Culture

- UK: more autonomous caregiving
- Uganda: more relational/distributed caregiving



Sources of variation in parenting styles

- Bottom lines
 - Authoritative, 'middle class' parenting is not necessarily adaptive for everyone in all contexts.
 - There is simply no single pattern of parenting that is optimal for all children, cultures, or subcultures

Study Finds Every Style Of Parenting Produces Disturbed, Miserable Adults

10/26/11 10:30am • SEE MORE: SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY ✓

 the ONION®



SANTA ROSA, CA—A study released by the California Parenting Institute Tuesday shows that every style of parenting inevitably causes children to grow into profoundly unhappy adults. "Our research suggests that while overprotective parenting ultimately produces adults unprepared to contend with life's difficulties, highly permissive parenting leads to feelings of bitterness and isolation throughout adulthood," lead researcher Daniel

Variation in family life

1. Donor insemination families

2. LGBTQ+ families



3. Divorce

- Parents
 - *Custodial mothers* are slightly more likely to be impatient, and less sensitive to child's needs
 - *Noncustodial fathers* are a bit more likely to be permissive and indulgent.
- Children
 - In general, divorce is tough on kids at all ages
 - In the long term, most kids do OK
 - Stable 1-parent home > conflict-ridden 2-parent home



Variation in family life

4. Imprisoned mothers



<https://www.washingtonpost.com/news/local/wp/2018/05/11/feature/prisons-are-allowing-mothers-to-raise-their-babies-behind-bars-but-is-the-radical-experiment-in-parenting-and-punishment-a-good-idea/>